Nakasendo Wayfarer · Trail & duck-out points

Walk Japan self-guided · 13–19 Nov 2026 · Ena → Tokyo · group of 3

Planned times assume a leisurely **30 min per km**, plus 15 min per 100 m of climbing and a 45 min lunch, starting when you leave the inn (7:00) or when the tour transfer drops you off. Departure times are the best found for Nov 2026; **≈ marks an estimate**. Check times locally, carry cash, and follow your Walk Japan notes where they differ.

The week at a glance

DAY	ROUTE	DISTANCE	WALK (PLANNED)	EXITS	NO-EXIT KM	TONIGHT
Day 2 Sat 14 Nov	Ena → Nakatsugawa → Magome	18 km ↑ 440 m	7:00 → 17:51	3	3.0 km	Guest House Motomiya, Magome 0573-69-2158
Day 3 Sun 15 Nov	Magome → O-Tsumago	6.5 km ↑ 260 m	7:00 → 10:54	3	0.0 km	Maruya Inn, O-Tsumago 0264-57-3117
Day 4 B Mon 16 Nov	O-Tsumago → Nagiso (Course B)	8 km ↑ 107 m	7:00 → 11:16	3	0.0 km	Iwaya Inn, Kiso-Fukushima 0264-22-2015
Day 4 A Mon 16 Nov	O-Tsumago → Nenoue Pass → Nojiri (Course A)	23 km ↑ 707 m	7:00 → 21:01	4	15.0 km	Iwaya Inn, Kiso-Fukushima 0264-22-2015
Day 5 Tue 17 Nov	Karasawa Falls → Kaida Plateau	13 km ↑ 640 m	7:25 → 16:16	2	10.0 km	Yamakanoyu, Kaida Kogen 0264-44-2010
Day 6 Wed 18 Nov	Yabuhara → Torii Pass → Narai	9 km ↑ 350 m	8:12 → 13:34	2	9.0 km	Le Grand Kyu Karuizawa 0267-41-2030
Day 7 Thu 19 Nov	Karuizawa → Usui Pass → Yokokawa	16 km ↑ 350 m	7:00 → 16:38	3	12.0 km	Your post-tour hotel in Tokyo (luggage is there)

How to read the day pages

Each day has a strip map of the walk, left to right, coloured by your escape options, then a table of every stop. **Duck-out** is the bus or train you can take from that stop. In the departures, **highlighted** is the first one after your planned arrival, and grey ones will already have gone.

bus/train exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: past the point of no return, keep going

1 stop with bus/train · 1 stop, no transport · 1 pass

Emergencies

119	Ambulance and fire	**110**	Police
050-3816-2787	Japan Visitor Hotline (JNTO), 24 h, English		

A Japanese/English version with phrases to show staff is in the companion PDF.

Day 2 · Ena → Nakatsugawa → Magome

Sat 14 Nov · 18 km · ↑440 m
walk 7:00 → ~17:51 · sunset 16:42



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

At 30 min/km this walk finishes ~17:51, after dark (sunset 16:42, dark ~17:09). Start earlier, shorten it, or take a duck-out.

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:00**	**Ena**	**JR Chuo Line train** → Nakatsugawa, ~10 min ≈ every 30 min (estimate). Skips the first 12 km.	6:00 6:30 **7:00** 7:30 8:00 8:30 9:00 9:30 10:00 10:30 11:00 11:30 12:00 12:30 13:00 13:30 14:00 14:30 15:00 15:30 16:00 16:30 17:00 17:30 18:00 18:30 19:00 19:30 20:00 20:30 21:00 21:30
2	12	**13:22**	**Nakatsugawa Stn**	**Kitaena bus** → Magome, ~25 min about hourly (Sat). 800 yen, cash.	8:15 9:10 9:55 10:45 11:15 12:15 13:15 **14:15** 15:15 16:15 17:45
3	15	**15:46**	**Ochiai-juku**	**Kitaena bus (Ochiai stop)** → Magome, ~13 min about hourly (≈ times). Last exit before the stone-paved climb.	8:27 9:22 10:07 10:57 11:27 12:27 13:27 14:27 15:27 **16:27** 17:57
4	16.3	**16:38**	**Stone-paved path**	No transport	
5	18	**17:51**	**Magome**	Walk ends	

Where turning back matters

🟨 km 15.0–16.8: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Ochiai-juku.

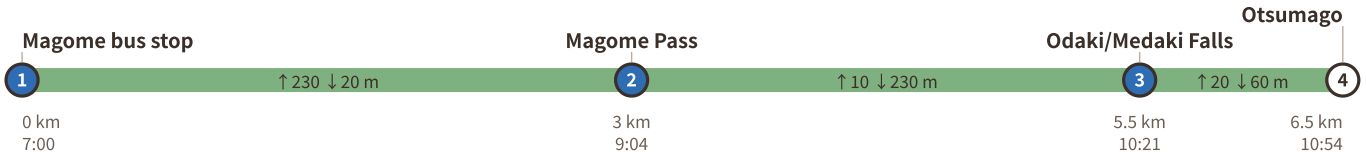
🟥 km 16.8–18.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Magome is quicker than turning back.

Tonight

Guest House Motomiya, Magome · ☎ **0573-69-2158** · 4944-2 Magome, Nakatsugawa, Gifu

Day 3 · Magome → O-Tsumago

Sun 15 Nov · 6.5 km · ↑260 m
walk 7:00 → ~10:54 · sunset 16:41



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:00**	**Magome bus stop**	**Ontake Kotsu bus** → Otsumago, ~21 min 4 a day. Cash.	**10:55** 13:25 15:00 17:15
2	3	**9:04**	**Magome Pass**	**Ontake Kotsu bus** → Otsumago, ~10 min 4 a day	**11:06** 13:36 15:11 17:26
3	5.5	**10:21**	**Odaki/Medaki Falls**	**Ontake Kotsu bus** → Otsumago, ~5 min 4 a day. Bus stop near the falls.	**11:11** 13:41 15:16 17:31
4	6.5	**10:54**	**Otsumago**	Walk ends	

Where turning back matters

Bus or train exits all the way along.

Tonight

Maruya Inn, O-Tsumago · ☎ **0264-57-3117** · 1477 Otsumago, Nagiso, Nagano

Day 4 · Course B · O-Tsumago → Nagiso

Mon 16 Nov · 8 km · ↑107 m
walk 7:00 → ~11:16 · sunset 16:40



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:00**	**Otsumago bus stop**	**bus** → Nagiso Stn, ~14 min 4 a day	**11:16** 13:46 15:21 17:36
2	2	**8:03**	**Tsumago**	**bus** → Nagiso Stn, ~9 min 1–2 an hour. 300 yen.	7:39 **9:44** 9:50 10:40 11:21 11:44 11:50 13:00 13:24 13:50 15:26 15:40 16:10 16:14 17:41
3	8	**11:16**	**Nagiso Stn**	**JR train** → Kiso-Fukushima, ~50 min every 1–2 h. No IC cards: paper ticket, cash.	6:22 7:02 8:00 8:11 10:19 11:00 **12:19** 14:34 16:00 17:16 18:16 20:19 20:43 21:49

Where turning back matters

Bus or train exits all the way along.

Planned tour transport

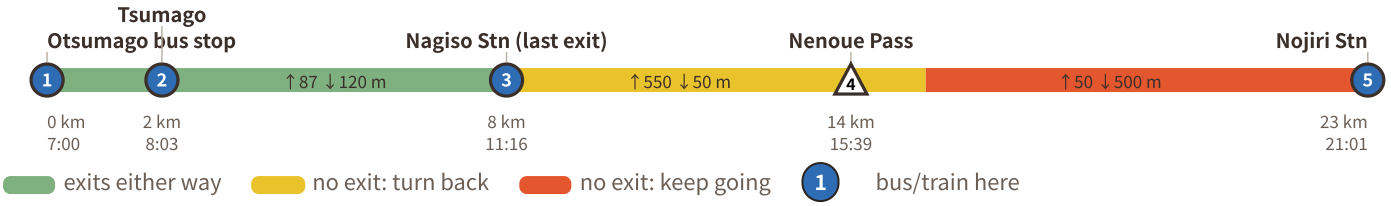
- After the walk: JR train Nagiso → Kiso-Fukushima, ~50 min (first after finishing: 12:19), then 5 min walk to Iwaya Inn.

Tonight

Iwaya Inn, Kiso-Fukushima · ☎ **0264-22-2015** · 5169 Fukushima, Kiso-machi, Nagano

Day 4 · Course A · O-Tsumago → Nenoue Pass → Nojiri

Mon 16 Nov · 23 km · ↑707 m
walk 7:00 → ~21:01 · sunset 16:40



At 30 min/km this walk finishes ~21:01, after dark (sunset 16:40, dark ~17:07). Start earlier, shorten it, or take a duck-out.

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:00**	**Otsumago bus stop**	**bus** → Nagiso Stn, ~14 min 4 a day	**11:16** 13:46 15:21 17:36
2	2	**8:03**	**Tsumago**	**bus** → Nagiso Stn, ~9 min 1–2 an hour. 300 yen.	7:39 **9:44** 9:50 10:40 11:21 11:44 11:50 13:00 13:24 13:50 15:26 15:40 16:10 16:14 17:41
3	8	**11:16**	**Nagiso Stn (last exit)**	**JR train** → Kiso-Fukushima, ~50 min every 1–2 h. LAST EXIT. Nothing until Nojiri (15 km, over Nenoue Pass). No IC cards.	6:22 7:02 8:00 8:11 10:19 11:00 **12:19** 14:34 16:00 17:16 18:16 20:19 20:43 21:49
4	14	**15:39**	**Nenoue Pass** (≈ location)	No transport	
5	23	**21:01**	**Nojiri Stn**	**JR train** → Kiso-Fukushima, ~40 min every 1–2 h (≈)	6:35 7:15 8:24 10:32 12:32 14:47 17:29 18:29 20:32 **22:02**

Where turning back matters

🟨 km 8.0–15.3: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Nagiso Stn (last exit).

🟥 km 15.3–23.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Nojiri Stn is quicker than turning back.

Planned tour transport

- After the walk: JR train Nojiri → Kiso-Fukushima, ~40 min (first after finishing: 22:02), then 5 min walk to Iwaya Inn.

Tonight

Iwaya Inn, Kiso-Fukushima · ☎ **0264-22-2015** · 5169 Fukushima, Kiso-machi, Nagano

Day 5 · Karasawa Falls → Kaida Plateau

Tue 17 Nov · 13 km · ↑640 m
walk 7:25 → ~16:16 · sunset 16:39



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:25**	**Karasawa Falls**	No bus or train here	
2	3.5	**10:10**	**Jizo Pass** (≈ location)	No transport	
3	6	**11:25**	**Kaida Info Centre**	**Kaida Kogen line bus** → Yamakanoyu, ~22 min roughly hourly (≈ times). Get off at Yamaka Ryokan-mae (the inn).	8:30 10:11 11:16 **12:28** 13:16 14:23 15:24 16:45 17:48 18:51 20:16
4	9	**13:44**	**Kaida Shisho**	**Kaida Kogen line bus** → Yamakanoyu, ~16 min roughly hourly. Get off at Yamaka Ryokan-mae (the inn).	8:36 10:17 11:22 12:34 13:22 **14:29** 15:30 16:51 17:54 18:57 20:22
5	11	**15:14**	**Nishino Pass** (≈ location)	No transport	
6	13	**16:16**	**Yamakanoyu**	Walk ends	

Where turning back matters

🟨 km 0.0–3.1: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Karasawa Falls (no bus or train there).

🟥 km 3.1–6.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Kaida Info Centre is quicker than turning back.

🟨 km 9.0–11.0: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Kaida Shisho.

🟥 km 11.0–13.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Yamakanoyu is quicker than turning back.

Planned tour transport

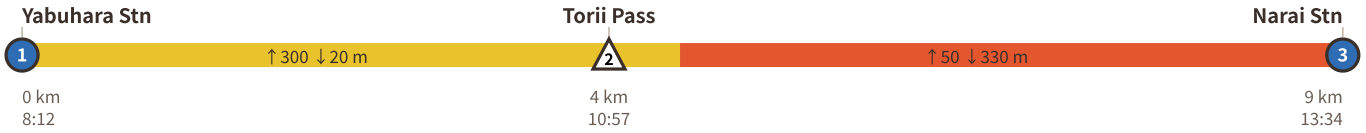
- Morning: tour taxi from Iwaya Inn to Karasawa Falls, about 25 min (≈). Walk starts ~7:25.

Tonight

Yamakanoyu, Kaida Kogen · ☎ **0264-44-2010** · 3109-1 Kaidakogen Nishino, Kiso-machi, Nagano

Day 6 · Yabuhara → Torii Pass → Narai

Wed 18 Nov · 9 km · ↑ 350 m
walk 8:12 → ~13:34 · sunset 16:38



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**8:12**	**Yabuhara Stn**	**JR train** → Narai, ~6 min every 1–2 h (≈). Ride one stop to Narai and meet the group. No IC cards.	7:32 **8:12** 9:21 11:29 13:29 15:44 18:26 19:26 21:29
2	4	**10:57**	**Torii Pass** (≈ location)	No transport	
3	9	**13:34**	**Narai Stn**	**JR train** → Shiojiri, ~20 min every 1–2 h (≈). Planned onward trip (see below).	7:38 8:18 9:27 11:35 **13:35** 15:50 18:32 19:32 21:35

Where turning back matters

🟨 km 0.0–4.5: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Yabuhara Stn.

🟥 km 4.5–9.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Narai Stn is quicker than turning back.

Planned tour transport

- Morning: tour vehicle from Yamakanoyu to Kiso-Fukushima Stn (~45 min, ≈), then the 7:52 train to Yabuhara (~20 min). Walk starts ~8:12.
- After the walk: train Narai → Shiojiri (~25 min, first after finishing: 13:35), Shinano limited express → Nagano (~50 min), Hokuriku shinkansen → Karuizawa (~30 min), then ~15 min walk to Le Grand Kyu. Your luggage goes to the post-tour hotel today: pack an overnight bag.

Tonight

Le Grand Kyu Karuizawa · ☎ **0267-41-2030** · 469-4 Oaza Karuizawa, Karuizawa-machi, Nagano

Day 7 · Karuizawa → Usui Pass → Yokokawa

Thu 19 Nov · 16 km · ↑ 350 m
walk 7:00 → ~16:38 · sunset 16:34



exits either way · no exit: turn back · no exit: keep going · 1 bus/train here

At 30 min/km this walk finishes ~16:38, in twilight (sunset 16:34).

#	KM	ETA	PLACE	DUCK-OUT	DEPARTURES
1	0	**7:00**	**Le Grand Kyu**	From **Karuizawa Stn**, +1 km walk **JR Bus Kanto, Usui line** → Yokokawa, ~34 min 8 a day (or shinkansen). From Karuizawa Stn (~1 km from the hotel). 520 yen cash, no IC cards.	6:59 **9:20** 11:05 12:55 14:20 15:35 16:30 18:05
2	4	**9:38**	**Usui Pass**	**Aka Bus (red bus), down** → Kyu-Karuizawa, ~20 min 5 down a day; cancelled in fog. Weather dependent.	**10:10** 11:00 11:45 12:45 14:00
3	13	**15:04**	**Sakamoto-juku** (≈ location)	No transport	
4	16	**16:38**	**Yokokawa Stn**	**JR Shin-etsu Line train** → Takasaki, ~33 min about hourly	5:18 6:10 6:43 7:10 7:36 8:10 8:43 9:28 10:10 11:10 12:04 13:04 14:10 15:10 16:00 16:30 **17:21** 18:13 18:50 19:32 20:19 21:42

Where turning back matters

🟨 km 4.0–9.0: no bus or train exit. If someone is struggling, turn back to Usui Pass.

🟥 km 9.0–16.0: past the point of no return. Carrying on to Yokokawa Stn is quicker than turning back.

Planned tour transport

- After the walk: JR Yokokawa → Takasaki (~33 min, first after finishing: 17:21), then shinkansen to Tokyo (~50 min).

Tonight

Your post-tour hotel in Tokyo (luggage is there)